

CANADA VS MOROCCO

Round of 16 opposition report: Morocco tactical profile, match data and Canada response.

MATCH LENS

Morocco arrive with a high-control 4-2-3-1 profile. Across the World Cup sample they have combined long spells of possession with repeated final-third access, strong line-breaking volume and reliable defensive contest work. Canada must protect central zones without losing the ability to attack quickly through wide-speed release and second balls.

1.39

MAR XG
avg PMSR sample

89%

MAR PASS %
PMSR sample

143

MAR FINAL 3RD REC.
avg PMSR sample

82

CAN 2ND BALLS
avg PMSR sample

33

CAN CROSSES
avg PMSR sample

MOROCCO MATCH THEMES

- Stable 4-2-3-1 base: Bounou starts the game; Hakimi/Mazraoui give width while El Aynaoui/Bouaddi connect possession.
- Central access: Morocco use Saibari, El Khannouss and Brahim to receive between the lines and combine before wide release.
- High-volume control: recent PMSR sample shows strong pass volume, final-third receptions and line breaks against varied opponents.
- Defensive balance: pressing is not always aggressive, but direct pressure and second-ball contest data remain consistent.

KEY MATCH INDICATORS

89%

MOROCCO PASS COMPLETION
PMSR sample

96

LINE BREAKS
Morocco avg

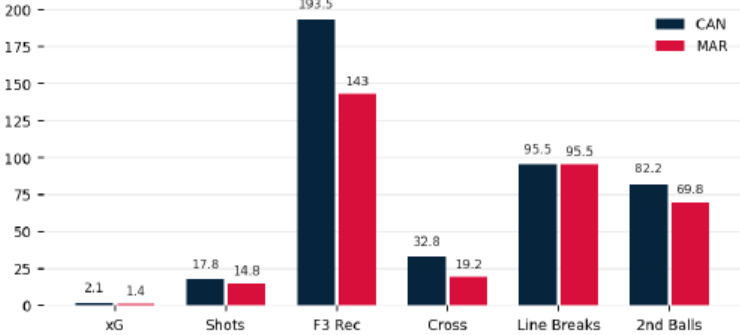
143

FINAL 3RD REC.
Morocco avg

82

CANADA 2ND BALLS
PMSR avg

PMSR match-summary averages



CANADA GAME READ

- Do not chase every Morocco circulation sequence; press on poor body shape, backwards passes or isolated full-back receives.
- Force Morocco away from central No.10 pockets and into wide service under pressure.
- Use Buchanan/Laryea speed and David/Larin references before Morocco reset their compact defensive block.
- Protect the first pass after loss: Morocco are dangerous when they can turn recoveries into controlled attacks.

PROJECTED LINEUPS & AVAILABILITY

Canada 4-4-2 against Morocco 4-2-3-1, with role logic tied to supplied match and team data.

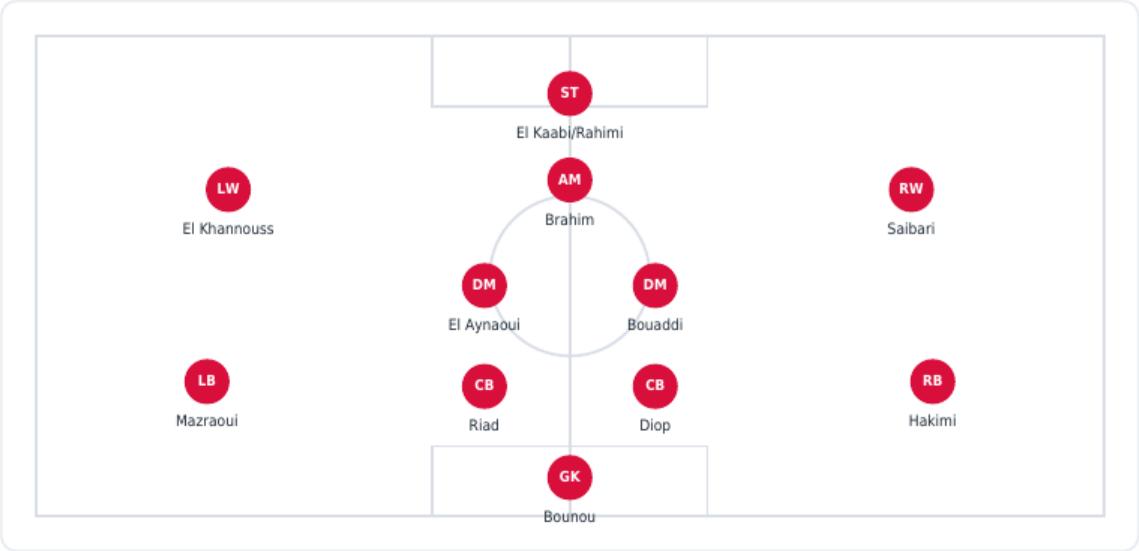
CANADA PROJECTED XI (4-4-2)



CANADA NOTE

- Canada should keep the 4-4-2 compact, but the wide mids must recover against Hakimi/Mazraoui.
- Eustaquio/Saliba screen Morocco access into Brahim/El Khannouss while still being ready to play forward after regain.
- David/Larin give Canada a direct outlet for early crosses and second-phase attacks.

MOROCCO PROJECTED XI (4-2-3-1)



MOROCCO ROLE NOTE

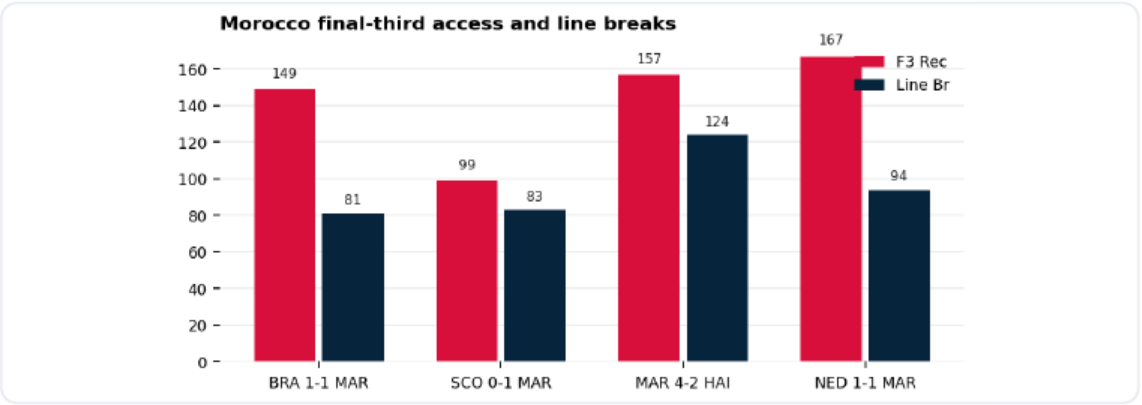
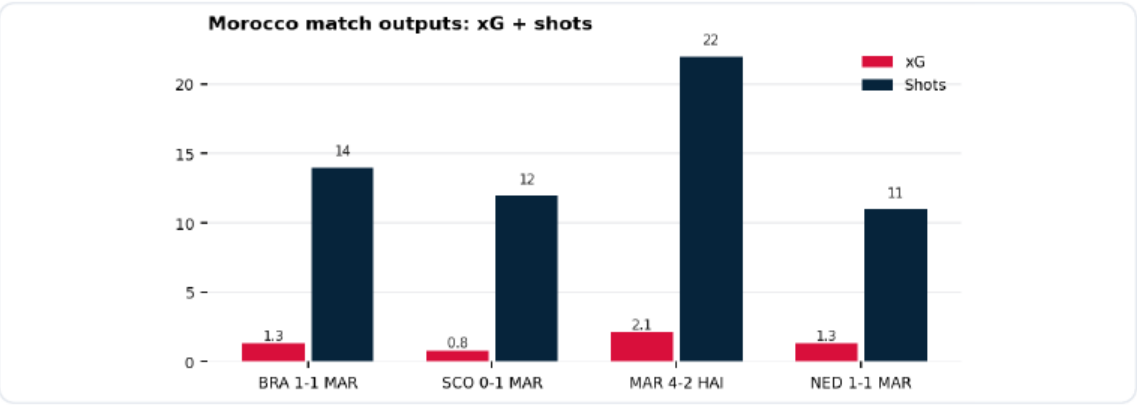
- Bounou plus the double pivot gives Morocco security in the first two phases.
- El Kaabi/Rahimi plus the double pivot gives Morocco security in the first two phases.
- El Khannouss/Mazraoui provide wide width while the attacking midfield line rotates inside.
- Saibari/Brahim/El Khannouss create a flexible pocket behind the striker, forcing Canada to protect Zone 14.

PLAYER-DATA / PMSR REASON FOR THIS SHAPE

Layer	Data point	Canada read
Morocco build-up	848/891 pass peak vs NED	Long possession phases a
Morocco final-third acce	167 F3 receptions vs NED	Canada cannot defend onl
Canada wide attack	33.8 crosses avg PMSR	Best route is wide-speed
Canada contest edge	82.3 second balls avg PM	Use first contacts to su

WORLD CUP MATCH SAMPLE

Match	xG	Shots	SOT	Pass	Pass%	Line Breaks	F3 Rec	Cross	2nd Balls
BRA 1-1 MAR	1.3	14	3	503	86	81	149	14	79
SCO 0-1 MAR	0.8	12	2	676	91	83	99	13	61
MAR 4-2 HAI	2.1	22	11	557	89	124	157	31	64
NED 1-1 MAR	1.3	11	5	891	91	94	167	19	75



SAMPLE READ

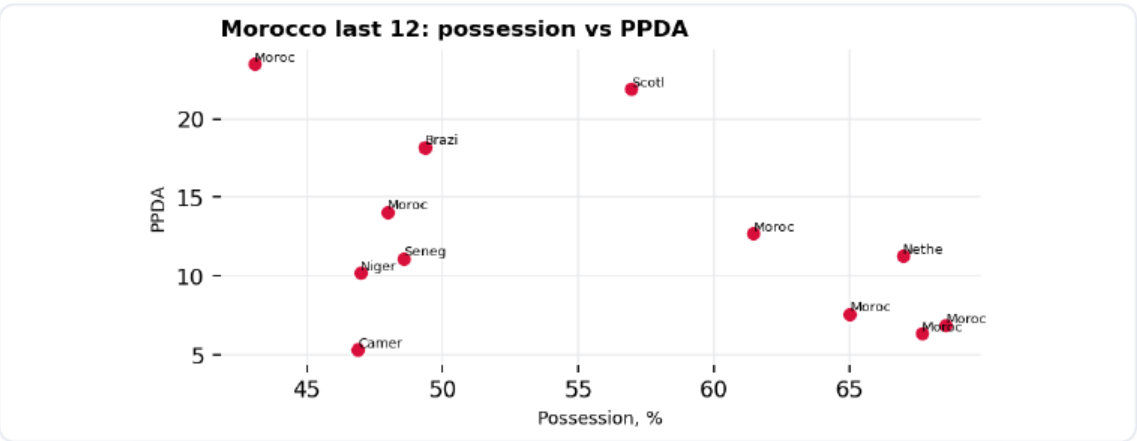
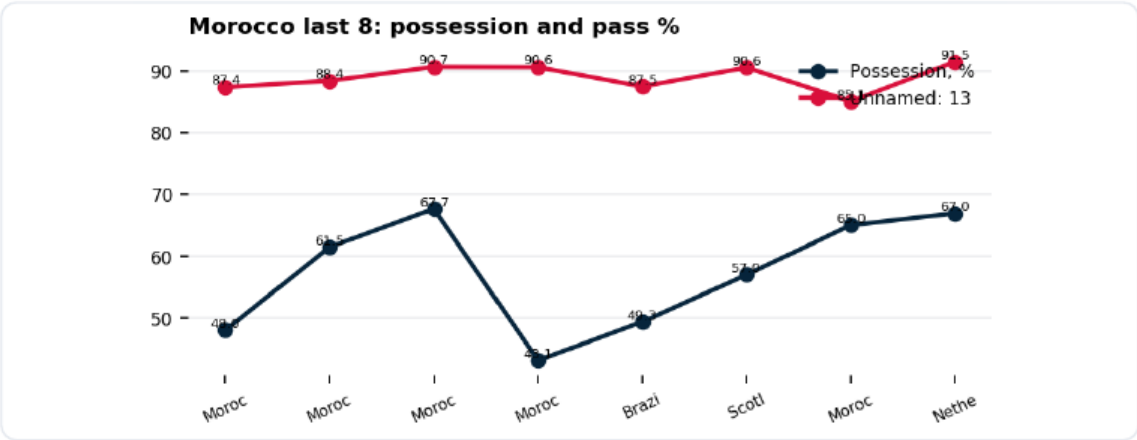
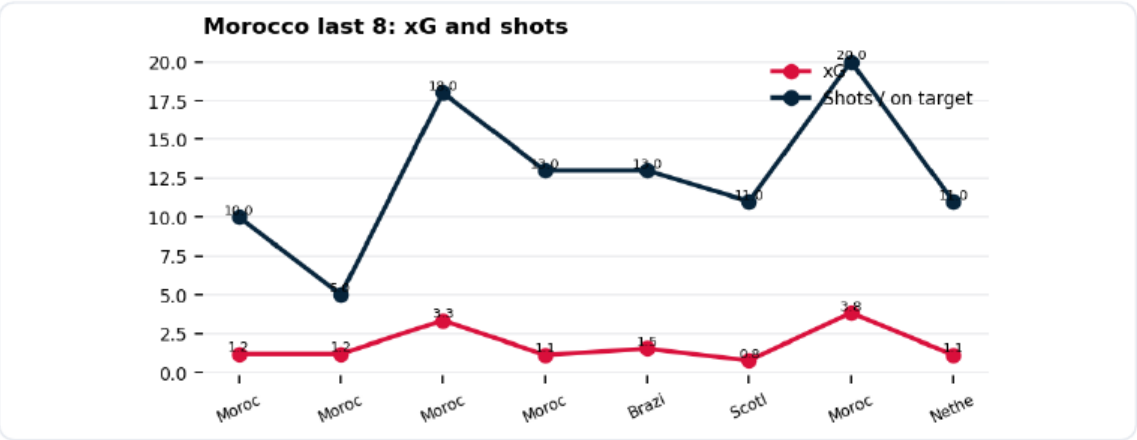
- Morocco average 657 passes and 89% completion across the four-match PMSR sample.
- Morocco final-third access is consistent: 143 receptions and 96 line breaks per match.
- Highest attacking output came against Haiti: 2.12 xG, 22 shots and 31 crosses.

CANADA IMPLICATION

- Canada should press moments, not possession totals: Morocco can pass through loose pressure.
- First defensive job is central lane control around Brahim/El Khannouss/Saibari.
- Canada’s fastest route is early wide release into Buchanan/Laryea/Millar before Morocco’s rest defence settles.

RECENT FORM TREND DATA

Last-calendar-year TeamStats sample: xG, possession, pass completion and PPDA patterns.



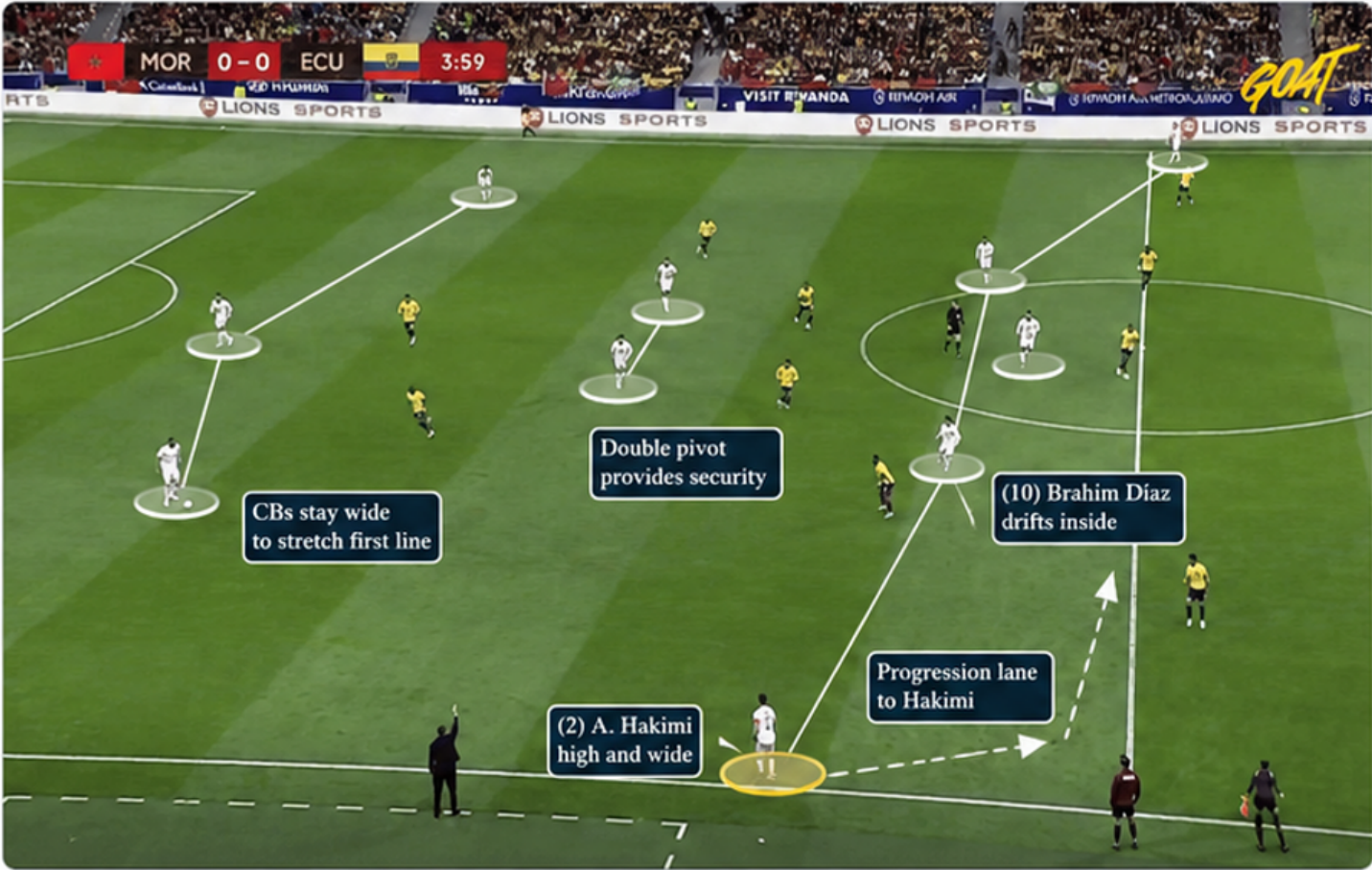
Date	Match	Goals	xG	Shots / on target	Possession, %	PPDA
2026-03-27	MAR - Ecuador 1:1	1	1.2	10	47	14.1
2026-03-31	MAR - Paraguay 2:1	2	1.2	5	61.5	12.7
2026-06-02	MAR - Madagascar 4:0	4	3.3	18	67.7	6.3
2026-06-07	MAR - Norway 1:1	1	1.1	13	43.1	23.5
2026-06-14	BRA - MAR 1:1	1	1.5	13	49.3	18.2
2026-06-20	SCO - MAR 0:1	1	0.8	11	56	21.9
2026-06-25	MAR - Haiti 4:2	4	3.8	20	65	7.6
2026-06-30	NED - MAR 1:1 (P)	1	1.1	11	66	11.3

TREND INTERPRETATION

- Morocco's trend sample shows a flexible possession profile: they can control matches with high pass volume, but also manage balanced possession against stronger opponents.
- The World Cup sample has been more stable than the broader form line: possession has stayed above 45% in every match and final-third access has remained high.
- Canada must decide when to press and when to hold; over-pressing leaves the central pocket open for Morocco's attacking midfield line.

BUILD-UP STRUCTURE: IMAGE ANALYSIS

How Morocco organize first phase, open Hakimi, and access central receivers.



DIAGONAL SWITCH TO UNLOCK THE RIGHT SIDE



 Pass% 89.2 High circulation from build-up	 Line Br 95.5 Repeated line breaks per game	 F3 Rec 143.0 Final-third receptions	 Ball Prog 36.5 Progressive carries per game
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IMAGE TAKEAWAYS

- Base shape often settles into a 4-2-3-1/4-1-4-1, with Hakimi high on the right touchline and Brahim Díaz drifting inside.
- The double pivot gives circulation security while the centre-backs recycle until the lane into the right side or No.10 opens.
- When the first line is pressed, Morocco can skip through a diagonal pass into the wide fullback or second-line midfielder.

CANADA PRESSING RESPONSE

- **Lock the first pass inside** and angle pressure toward Morocco's left centre-back whenever possible.
- David/Larin must screen the pivot before jumping wide; Eustáquio and Saliba need compact distances behind them.
- When Hakimi receives, the nearest winger must recover quickly and prevent the turn up the line.

BUILD-UP CLAIM

Morocco's first phase is calm and repeatable rather than chaotic. Canada's first task is to deny the central connection and only then spring pressure toward the touchline.

MIDFIELD CONTROL & PROGRESSION

Morocco progress through interior rotations, diagonal switches and quick release into runners.



CANADA MIDFIELD KEYS

- One pivot must screen while the other engages; both cannot jump beyond the ball at the same time.
- Morocco use Brahim Díaz between the lines as the first reference after a regain or switch.
- Fullbacks must open early to defend the far-side diagonal and the next run beyond.
- If Canada regain centrally, the first pass should go forward before Morocco's counter-press arrives.

TACTICAL READ

The biggest midfield problem is not pure possession volume but Morocco's ability to move the block with one central touch and one switch. Canada must protect the interior first and then manage the far-side release.

MOROCCO ATTACKING PROFILE

The threat comes from wide release, box occupation, cutbacks and second-phase attacks.

1

WIDE RELEASE TO FAR-POST RUNNER



Early wide delivery targets the far-post runner.

2

ATTACK THE HALF-SPACE, RECYCLE & CUTBACK



Morocco attack the half-space, pull defenders, then cut back.

3

BOX OCCUPATION & SECOND-PHASE THREAT



Crowded six-yard and penalty-spot zones + late runner.



xG

1.39



Shots

14.8



Crosses

19.2



F3 Rec

143.0

ATTACKING EVIDENCE

- Wing service arrives early from wide right and left channels, often toward the far-post runner.
- Morocco attack the space between fullback and centre-back, then recycle for second entries and cutbacks.
- Box occupation is aggressive: front line plus a late midfielder attack the six-yard and penalty-spot zones.

CANADA RESPONSE

- Weak-side fullback must tuck earlier when the ball is delivered from the opposite side.
- Clear first contact away from zone 14; Morocco are dangerous on the second ball.
- Centre-backs must communicate early on blind-side runners and back-post traffic.

ATTACKING PATTERN READ

Morocco are most dangerous when the initial wide action creates a second action inside the box. Canada must survive the first cross and immediately reset for the next touch.



WIDE RELEASE



PULL DEFENDERS



CUTBACK



SECOND-PHASE THREAT

DEFENSIVE SHAPE & PRESSING CUES

Morocco defend compactly, jump on triggers and break quickly when the ball turns over.



Press

240.2



Direct

54.5



Forced TO

45.0



Recoveries

71.9

CANADA ESCAPE PLAN



- Use third-man support near the touchline and bounce passes to escape the first trap.



- Switch the point quickly after attracting Morocco to one side.



- Prevent open-field transition by securing rest-defence behind the ball.

1. COMPACT BLOCK & PRESSING TRIGGERS



Morocco stay compact in two lines, protecting the centre and jumping on loose touches and backwards passes.

2. FORCE WIDE THEN STEP



Ball is funnelled to the flank. The nearest defender presses, while the block shifts and maintains compact distances.

3. WIN IT & ATTACK THE SPACE



On regaining possession, Morocco look to play forward quickly into the channels or switch early into open space.

DEFENSIVE MATCHUP READ



- Morocco protect the centre with a compact 4-1-4-1/4-4-2 block and force play wide before stepping.



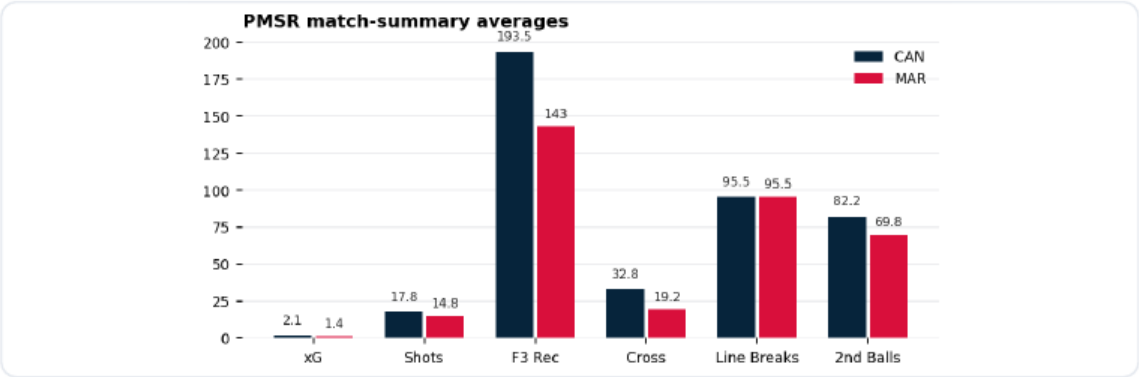
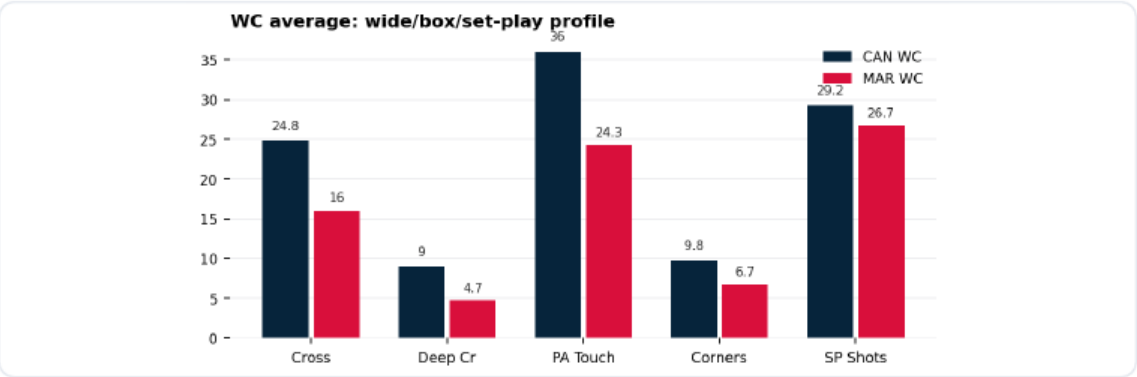
- Pressing triggers include loose touches, backwards passes and exposed fullbacks.



- Once the ball is won, the first look is an early diagonal release or vertical carry into open space.

CANADA DATA MATCHUP

Canada metrics are used where they change the Morocco match plan: width, second balls and pressure.



Matchup	Data point	Canada action
Canada wide service	32.8 crosses PMSR avg	Attack early before Moro
Canada second balls	82.2 second balls PMSR a	Use David/Larin first co
Morocco final-third cont	143.0 F3 rec PMSR avg	Canada must protect Zone
Morocco possession	89% pass completion	Press selectively; avoid

BEST CANADA ROUTES

- Quick switches before Morocco’s compact midfield shifts across.
- Buchanan/Laryea speed into the wide channel; early crosses before the block sets.
- David/Larin first contacts with Eustaquio/Saliba arriving to collect second balls.
- Counterpress immediately after Canada loses possession in the attacking half.

MATCHUP SUMMARY

Canada should not chase possession dominance. The data points to fast first passes, wide speed, cross/cutback variety and second-ball control as the practical route to attack Morocco while protecting against their possession game.

CANADA MATCH PLAN

Final coaching sheet using the expanded statistical sample and the Morocco playing-style profile.

1. OUT OF POSSESSION

- Screen Morocco’s first pass into the No.10 pocket.
- Keep central compactness before pressing wide.
- Track Hakimi/Mazraoui support runs once the ball reaches the sideline.

2. IN POSSESSION

- First pass after regain must be secure and forward/wide.
- Attack before Morocco reset their compact 4-2-3-1/4-4-2 block.
- Use David/Larin as central references for crosses and second phases.

3. BOX & SET PLAYS

- Defend the six-yard line and the cutback lane.
- Clear second balls outside the box; do not give Morocco repeated delivery.
- When Canada attack corners, hold transition security against Hakimi/Rahimi releases.

4. KEY MATCHUPS

- Johnston/Buchanan vs Mazraoui/El Khannouss side management.
- Laryea/Ali Ahmed vs Hakimi/Saibari wide-space battle.
- Eustaquio/Saliba vs El Aynaoui/Bouaddi tempo and second-ball control.

MATCH PLAN IN ACTION



STAY COMPACT

Do not let Morocco split the midfield screen. Force wide and manage the next pass.



STOP CENTRAL ACCESS

Protect Zone 14 before stepping out. Canada’s first pressure must not expose the pocket.



ATTACK QUICKLY

Canada’s best moments come before opponents reset; use wide-speed release and second balls.

WINNING CONDITIONS

1

Central screen

2

Secure first pass

3

Wide-speed release

4

Cutback defence

5

Second-ball control